UNIT II - VOCABULARY BUILDING AND PRONUNCIATION

1. Word Formation

- **Prefix** (added at the start): un-happy, dis-agree, re-write, mis-understand, pre-view.
- **Suffix** (added at the end): happi-ness, care-ful, teach-er, act-ion, quick-ly.
- **Compounding** (two words joined): sun + flower = sunflower; black + board = blackboard.
- **Blending:** breakfast + lunch = brunch; smoke + fog = smog.
- **Clipping:** examination = exam; laboratory = lab.
- **Acronyms:** NASA, UNESCO, laser.

2. Synonyms and Antonyms

Word	Synonym	Antonym
Brave	Courageous	Cowardly
Rapid	Quick	Slow
Ancient	Old	Modern
Generous	Liberal	Stingy
Permit	Allow	Forbid
Victory	Triumph	Defeat
Create	Make	Destroy
Honest	Truthful	Dishonest

3. Homonyms

Words that sound or look the same but differ in meaning. **Homophones** sound the same but are spelt differently; **homographs** are spelt the same but have different meanings.

Homophones	Meaning
there / their / they're	in that place / belonging to them / they are
to / too / two	towards / also / the number 2
write / right	to put words on paper / correct
piece / peace	a part / calm
principal / principle	head of a school / a rule or belief
bear (animal) / bear (carry)	homograph with different meanings

4. One-Word Substitutes

Phrase	One word
A person who writes his own life story	Autobiographer (the book: autobiography)
A child whose parents are dead	Orphan
One who does not believe in God	Atheist
A lover of books	Bibliophile
One who hates mankind	Misanthrope

Phrase	One word
One who eats both plants and meat	Omnivorous
A person who walks on foot	Pedestrian
A place where birds are kept	Aviary
Government by the people	Democracy
That which cannot be read	Illegible
A person who speaks many languages	Polyglot

5. Changing One Part of Speech to Another

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
beauty	beautify	beautiful	beautifully
success	succeed	successful	successfully
decision	decide	decisive	decisively
strength	strengthen	strong	strongly
choice	choose	choosy	-
pleasure	please	pleasant	pleasantly

6. Odd-One-Out

Find the word that does not belong to the group.

Examples

1. Apple, mango, carrot, banana - **carrot** (a vegetable; the rest are fruits).
2. Happy, joyful, cheerful, sad - **sad** (the rest are synonyms).
3. Run, jump, walk, table - **table** (a noun; the rest are verbs).
4. Chennai, Madurai, Delhi, Coimbatore - **Delhi** (not in Tamil Nadu).

7. Idioms and Phrases

Idiom	Meaning	Example
A piece of cake	Very easy	The test was a piece of cake.
Break the ice	Start a conversation	He told a joke to break the ice.
Once in a blue moon	Very rarely	We meet once in a blue moon.
Spill the beans	Reveal a secret	Don't spill the beans about the party.
Hit the nail on the head	Say exactly the right thing	You hit the nail on the head.
Burn the midnight oil	Work late at night	She burnt the midnight oil before exams.
Under the weather	Slightly unwell	I am feeling under the weather.
Cost an arm and a leg	Very expensive	That phone cost an arm and a leg.

8. Joining Sentences

- **Coordinating conjunctions** (and, but, or, so): It was late. We left. = It was late, so we left.
- **Subordinating conjunctions** (because, although, if, when, since): He was tired. He kept working. = **Although** he was tired, he kept working.
- **Relative pronouns** (who, which, that): I met a man. He teaches music. = I met a man **who** teaches music.
- **Participles:** She opened the door. She walked in. = **Opening** the door, she walked in.
- **too...to / so...that:** He is too weak to walk. = He is so weak that he cannot walk.

9. Vowel and Consonant Sounds

English has 5 vowel *letters* (a, e, i, o, u) and 21 consonant letters, but about **44 sounds** in standard British pronunciation: **20 vowel sounds** (12 pure vowels or monophthongs and 8 diphthongs) and **24 consonant sounds**.

- **Pure vowels** keep one steady sound: as in *sit*, *see*, *set*, *cat*, *cut*, *put*, *food*, *saw*, *hot*, *hurt*, *car*, *about*.
- **Diphthongs** glide from one vowel sound to another: as in *day*, *go*, *high*, *boy*, *now*, *here*, *hair*, *tour*.
- **Consonants** are grouped by voicing (voiced like b, d, g, v, z; voiceless like p, t, k, f, s), by place (lips, teeth, tongue ridge, throat) and by manner (stops, fricatives, nasals).
- Spelling does not match sound: *though*, *through*, *tough*, *cough* all end in 'ough' but sound different. Always check a dictionary.

10. Word Stress

In words of more than one syllable, one syllable is spoken louder, longer and higher. Wrong stress can make a word hard to understand.

- Two-syllable **nouns and adjectives** usually stress the first syllable: **TA**ble, **PRE**sent (noun), **CLE**ver.
- Two-syllable **verbs** usually stress the second syllable: pre**SENT** (verb), de**CIDE**, re**PORT**.
- Words ending in **-tion, -sion, -ic, -ical, -ity** stress the syllable just before the ending: edu**CA**tion, e**CO**nomic, ca**PA**city.
- The same spelling can change stress with meaning: **REC**ord (noun) and re**CORD** (verb); **OB**ject and ob**JECT**.

11. Sentence Stress

In a sentence, **content words** (nouns, main verbs, adjectives, adverbs, negatives) are stressed. **Function words** (articles, prepositions, auxiliaries, pronouns) are usually weak.

Example

I want to BUY a NEW BOOK from the SHOP.

Changing the stress changes the meaning: **I** did not take your pen (someone else did) / I did not **take** your pen (I borrowed it) / I did not take **your** pen (I took another).

12. Intonation

Intonation is the rise and fall of the voice while speaking. It shows meaning, attitude and emotion.

Pattern	Used for	Example
Falling	Statements, commands, wh-questions	Where do you LIVE? (falls)
Rising	Yes/no questions, requests, doubt	Are you COMING? (rises)
Fall-rise	Uncertainty, polite correction	Well... I SUPPose so.

Pattern	Used for	Example
Rising, rising, falling	Lists	I bought apples, oranges, and BANANAS.

13. Practice in Pronunciation

- Listen to native or standard speakers (news, podcasts) and repeat aloud.
- Use a dictionary with audio to check each new word.
- Record your own voice and compare it with a model.
- Practise tongue twisters: 'She sells sea shells on the sea shore.'
- Practise minimal pairs: ship / sheep, bit / beat, pull / pool, think / sink.